

CADENCE

Theatre Rota, On-Call, and Staff Scheduling

User Guide

University Hospitals Plymouth NHS Trust
Cardiothoracic Theatres

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Contents

1. Introduction

What is Cadence?

Cadence is the department's own theatre rota system — built specifically for how Cardiac Theatres actually works, rather than adapted from a generic scheduling tool. It replaces the previous spreadsheet-and-printout approach with a single, always-up-to-date system that everyone in the department can check from a phone, tablet, or computer.

It covers the weekly theatre rota, the on-call rota, a month-at-a-glance on-call calendar, individual staff statistics, and department-wide administration — all built around the same underlying data, so nothing has to be entered twice.

Who it's for

- **Everyone in the department** can view the rota, the on-call calendar, and staff profiles from any device.
- **Editors** (typically senior ODPs or coordinators) can additionally build and publish the weekly rota.
- **Admins** can additionally manage theatres, staff, user accounts, and department-wide settings.

Section 11 has a full breakdown of what each role can and can't do.

Key benefits

- **One source of truth.** Everyone sees the same live rota — no separate copies to keep in sync, and no risk of someone working from an outdated printout.
- **Available anywhere.** Works on a phone, iPad, or desktop, and can be installed like a normal app on a phone or tablet home screen.
- **Works with no signal.** Once you've opened the app, it keeps working with poor or no wifi — useful in theatre corridors and changing rooms. Any changes made offline sync automatically once signal returns.
- **Built-in accountability.** Every rota change is logged automatically — who changed what, and when — visible to admins under Administration.
- **Reduces errors.** The system won't let the same person be double-booked across two theatres on the same day, and on-call cover is always visible at a glance.
- **Learns from your own history.** Theatre Intelligence and Staff Profiles surface genuine patterns from your published rotas — busiest theatres, on-call workload, regular pairings — with no manual reporting required.
- **Grows with the department.** Built to eventually support other teams (for example, theatre nursing) alongside ODPs and anaesthetists, and to support more than one department if it's rolled out further.

2. Getting Started

Signing in

Go to the Cadence web address given to you by your admin. Enter the email address and password you were given, and select Sign in.

The first time you're given an account, you'll be given a temporary password by your admin directly. It's worth changing this to something memorable once you're in — see Section 8.

Forgot your password?

On the sign-in screen, select Forgot password? and enter your email address. You'll be sent a link to set a new password. For security, you'll see the same confirmation message whether or not that email has an account — this is normal and not an error.

Roles at a glance

Role	Can view rota, calendar, profiles	Can edit and publish the rota	Can manage theatres, staff, accounts
Viewer	Yes	No	No
Editor	Yes	Yes	No
Admin	Yes	Yes	Yes

Your role is set by your admin when your account is created, and can be changed at any time under Administration → User accounts.

3. Dashboard

The Dashboard is the home screen — a live snapshot of the department for whichever day you're looking at.

Live theatre status

Each theatre appears as its own card, showing:

- A status dot — available (grey), a list running (teal, pulsing), or closed (e.g. NO LIST/maintenance).
- The list type, if one has been set (ROUTINE, EMERGENCY, or a custom value).
- The ODP(s) and anaesthetist allocated for that day.

Week and day navigation

Use Previous week / Next week to move between weeks, and This week to jump straight back to today. The row of day tabs lets you flip through any day of the selected week — today's tab is always outlined even when you're looking at a different day.

If a bank holiday has been set up in Administration, it's flagged automatically at the top of the page on the relevant day.

Sessions and on-call summary

Three summary cards show the number of theatres running that day, who's on call as ODP (with a FROM HOME badge if that's been marked), and who's on call as anaesthetist.

Theatre Intelligence

A rotating set of genuine facts pulled from the department's own published rota history — total sessions run, the busiest theatre, the busiest day of the week, who's covered the most on-call or Support shifts, and the most frequent ODP/anaesthetist pairing. Select Shuffle to see a different set. Facts only ever appear once there's enough real history behind them — it won't state something as a pattern from a single data point.

My Week

Select your name once from the list and Cadence remembers it on that device. From then on, My Week shows your placements across all seven days of whichever week you're viewing — which theatre, on-call, Support, or “Not rostered” for each day. Select Not you? Switch name to change it.

4. Rota

This is where the weekly rota is built. Viewers see it read-only; Editors and Admins can make changes.

Editing a week

Use the date picker to choose which week you're working on — it always opens on the current week by default. Each theatre has slots for up to two ODPs, an anaesthetist, and a list type. Support and on-call are set separately per day.

Note: Selecting someone as an ODP or anaesthetist in one theatre automatically removes them from the dropdown in every other theatre for that day — it isn't possible to accidentally double-book someone across two theatres. On-call dropdowns always show everyone, regardless of who's already allocated elsewhere that day.

List types

Each theatre and the Support slot has a list-type field — ROUTINE, EMERGENCY, and URGENT are included by default, and an admin can add department-specific values (e.g. NO LIST, THORACIC, CARDIAC) under Administration → List types.

On-call

Weekdays show a single on-call ODP and anaesthetist, plus a From home tickbox for when on-call is being covered remotely. Weekends show two ODP slots each with a session (ALL DAY / AM / PM), an on-call anaesthetist, and a weekend waiting-list ODP and anaesthetist.

Clearing and saving

- **Clear week** wipes every box for the week currently on screen (with a confirmation prompt) — useful for starting a week from scratch.
- **Save draft** saves your progress without making it visible on the Dashboard, Calendar, or Staff Profiles.
- **Publish** makes the week live everywhere — this is also what feeds Theatre Intelligence and Staff Profiles, so a week needs to be published (not just saved as a draft) to count toward those statistics.

Full week view

Shows the whole week — weekday and weekend — in a clean, read-only layout with the hospital and department name at the top, the same style used for printing. Useful for a quick visual check before publishing. Select Back to editing to return to normal.

Print preview

Prints the current week formatted for A4 landscape, with the hospital name, department name, and week-commencing date at the top — ready to put up in the department.

5. On Call Calendar

A month-at-a-glance view of on-call cover — who's covering, for every day of the month, without having to open each week individually.

- Bank holidays are marked with a coloured outline and a small dot.
- Today is highlighted.
- Selecting any day jumps straight to that day on the Dashboard.
- Use Previous month / Next month to browse, and This month to jump back to today's month.

6. Staff Profiles

Look up any ODP or anaesthetist to see their history, built entirely from published rota data:

- Total theatre sessions worked, on-call count, and Support duty count.
- Their favourite (most-worked) theatre.
- A work-pattern breakdown by day of the week.
- Their most frequent colleague — for an ODP, the anaesthetist they've worked with most, and vice versa.
- Badges for notable milestones — Regular (20+ sessions), On-call veteran (10+ shifts), Team player (worked with 5+ colleagues), and a “[Theatre] regular” badge where one theatre clearly dominates.

As with Theatre Intelligence, this only ever reflects published weeks, and is honest about showing “no history yet” rather than guessing.

7. Administration

Visible only to Admins. This is where the department itself is configured.

Department details

The hospital/Trust name and department name shown on the printed rota and Full week view.

Theatres

Add or remove theatres. Removing a theatre doesn't delete any past rota data already recorded against it.

Staff

The list of ODPs and anaesthetists who can be allocated on the rota. This is separate from user accounts (Section below) — someone can be on the Staff list without having a login, and vice versa.

List types

The custom list-type values available throughout the rota (beyond the ROUTINE/EMERGENCY/URGENT defaults).

Bank holidays

Dates marked here appear automatically on the Rota, Dashboard, and On Call Calendar.

User accounts

Create a login for a new person — name, email, a temporary password (or use Generate for a random one), and a role. Give the person their email and password directly; there's no automatic invite email.

- Change someone's role at any time from the dropdown next to their name.
- Revoke access removes their ability to sign in to this department — it doesn't delete their underlying login entirely, but they can no longer get into this department's data.
- You can't change your own role or revoke your own access, so there's no way to accidentally lock yourself out.

Change log

An audit trail of the most recent rota changes — who made the change, when, and a preview of exactly which fields changed and what they changed from/to. Every save and publish is recorded automatically and can't be edited or deleted, so it's a genuine record for auditing purposes.

8. Your Account

Changing your password

Select the key icon next to Sign out in the sidebar to open your Account page, where you can set a new password at any time.

Dark mode and text size

Available from every screen, top-right: a moon icon toggles dark mode, and the – / + buttons step through three text sizes. Both preferences are remembered on that device.

Using Cadence on a phone

On a narrow screen, the sidebar is replaced by a menu icon (top-left) — select it to open the full navigation menu, and select outside it to close.

9. Installing Cadence as an App

Cadence can be installed like a normal app, with its own icon on your home screen — no app store needed.

On iPhone / iPad (Safari)

- Open Cadence in Safari.
- Select the Share icon.
- Select Add to Home Screen.

Works with no signal

Once you've opened Cadence at least once, the app itself keeps working even with no wifi or mobile signal — useful in theatre corridors. Any rota data you've already viewed stays available, and if you make a change while offline, it saves locally and syncs automatically the next time you have signal.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Signs in fine, then a blank white screen	Local data on that device is stuck	Wait — after 10 seconds you'll see a Reset and try again button. This clears local data and takes you back to sign-in without losing anything.
Blank screen specifically on an iPad in Safari	Safari's "Prevent Cross-Site Tracking" blocking the live data connection	In Safari, open the page-settings ("aA") icon in the address bar → Website Settings → turn off tracking prevention for this site only.
Can't remember password	—	Use Forgot password? on the sign-in screen.
Can't see Administration	Your account is set to Viewer or Editor	Ask an Admin to change your role, if appropriate.

11. Roles & Permissions — Full Reference

Area	Viewer	Editor	Admin
Dashboard, Calendar, Staff Profiles	View	View	View
Rota	View only	Edit, save, publish	Edit, save, publish
Theatre Intelligence	View	View	View
My Week / Account settings	Yes	Yes	Yes
Theatres, Staff list, List types, Bank holidays	No	No	Manage
User accounts	No	No	Manage
Change log	No	No	View

12. Looking Ahead

Cadence is under active development. Planned or under-consideration additions include:

- Data export (CSV/PDF) for payroll or Trust audit requests.
- A parallel module for theatre nursing staff, alongside the existing ODP/anaesthetist rota.
- Wider rollout to other departments and, longer term, other NHS Trusts.

This guide will be updated as new features are added.